

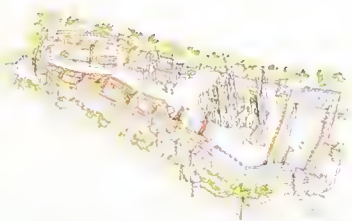


Castles



Did you know?

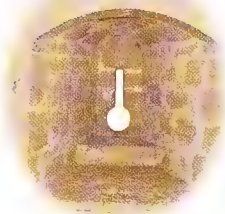
The world's largest castle is in Prague, Czech Republic. It has a cathedral inside!



Castles were once the homes of kings and lords. These strong buildings protected them from their enemies.

Flag

The flag carried the lord's coat of arms.



Arrow loop

Archers fired arrows through slits in the walls.



Drawbridge

Pulling up the drawbridge cut the castle off from enemies.



Portcullis

A metal grille protected the wooden gates.

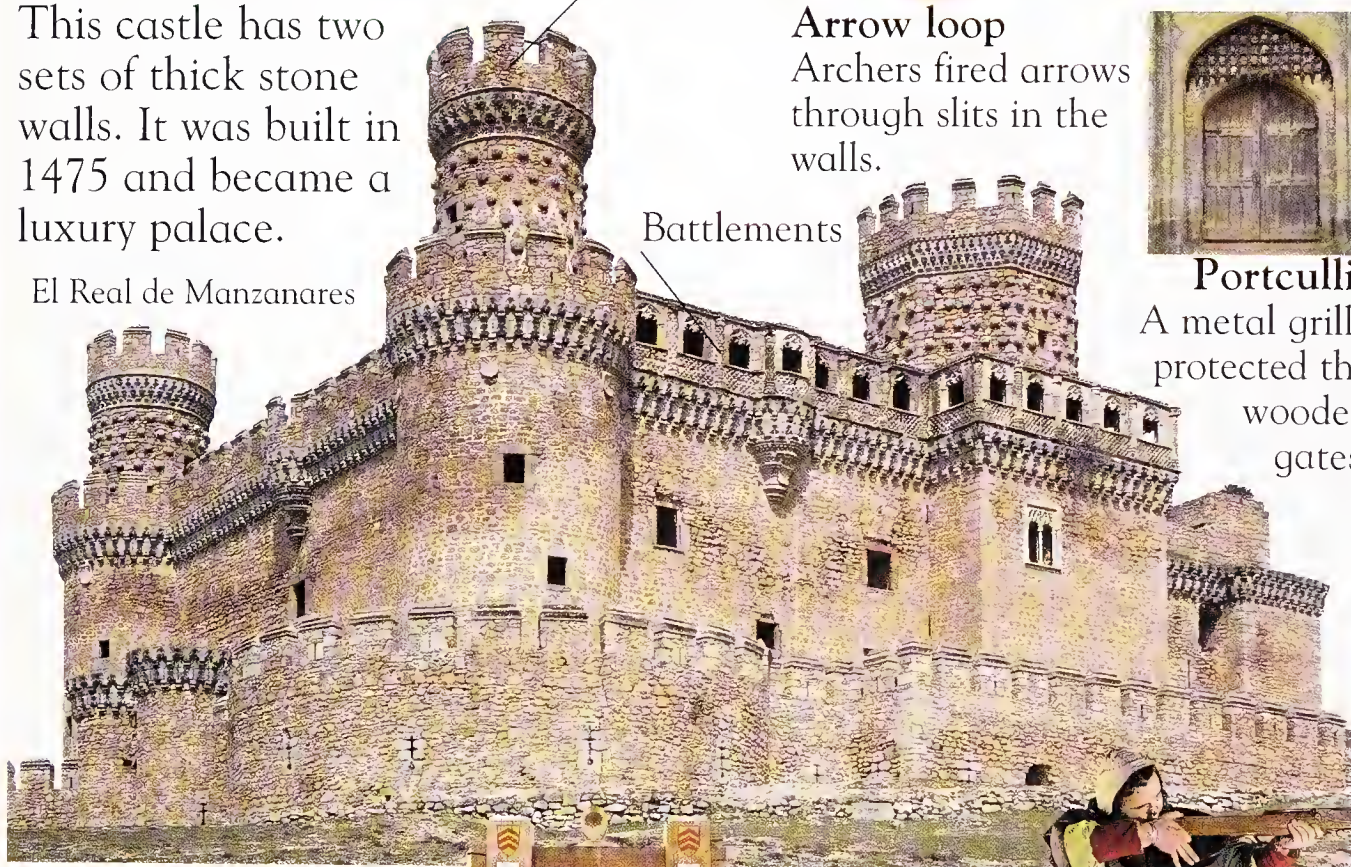
Spanish castle

This castle has two sets of thick stone walls. It was built in 1475 and became a luxury palace.

El Real de Manzanares

Turrets

Battlements



Laying siege

In a siege, an enemy army surrounded a castle and attacked it with powerful weapons.

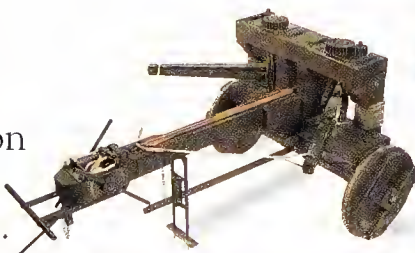


Giant catapults

hurled rocks and stones at the castle walls.

Crossbows

fired arrows at soldiers on the castle battlements.



Cannons began to be used in about 1350.



Archers were specially trained to fire crossbows.



Types of castles



Saumur castle lies on the banks of the Loire River in France. It has tall, pointed towers.



Caerphilly castle is the largest castle in Wales. It was built between 1268–1271.



Krak des Chevaliers was a huge Crusader fortress. It could house over 2,000 soldiers.

Neuschwanstein

looks like a fairy-tale castle. It was built in Germany in the 1800s.



George du Dades castle in Morocco has very high walls. It was hard to attack.

